Brighter Days

150+ Activities for Seniors

Simple, engaging ways to support memory, conversation, movement, and joy.



Boost Memory

Encourage Conversation

Support Movement

Bring Joy

MEMORY & REASONING

Puzzles, word games and brain teasers to keep the mind active and sharp.



LEVEL ●○○ Easy ●●○ Medium ●●● Challenging

45 activities

2 Finish the Saying ●●○
4 Say the Color! ●●○
6 Number Gym ●●○
8 Rhyme Time ●●○
10 Shape Sudoku ●●●
12 Sock Hop Word Search ●●○
14 Golden Age Movie Trivia ●●○
18 Then & Now ●○○
22 Kitchen Word Scramble ●●○
24 Odd One Out ●○○
26 Name Five! ●●○
28 Finish the Picture ●●●
30 Road Trip USA ●●○
32 Missing Vowels ●●○
35 Alphabet Garden ●●○
37 Grocery List Memory ●●●
39 Opposites Match ●○○
42 Perfect Pairs ●○○
45 Put It in Order ●●○
49 Finish the Lyric ●●○
53 Crossword: Around the House ●●●
57 Garden Party Word Search ●●○
61 Spot the Difference: Picnic Day ●●○
65 Find the Way Home ●●○
69 Counting Coins ●●○
73 What Time Is It? ●○○
76 Swinging Sixties Trivia ●●○
80 Word Ladder ●●●
85 Hidden Animals ●●○
89 Connect the Dots: Sailboat ●○○
93 Number Search ●●○
97 Around the World A to Z ●●●
100 Picture Memory ●●○
104 Missing Letters: U.S. States ●●○
108 Mixed-Up Sentences ●●○
112 Count the Shapes ●○○
116 Baseball Legends Trivia ●●○
121 Christmas Cheer Word Search ●●○
125 Complete the Pattern ●○○
128 Recipe Math ●●●
132 Compound Words ●●○
136 Sounds Alike ●●○
140 Who Owns the Cat? ●●●
144 Fourth of July Word Search ●●○
148 Classic TV Trivia ●●○

Choose by goal, pick the right level — and enjoy!

MOVEMENT & COORDINATION

Gentle movement, hand skills and seated games for every ability.



LEVEL ●○○ Easy ●●○ Medium ●●● Challenging

35 activities

15 Seated Hand Dance ●○○
19 Little Pot Garden ●○○
21 Sponge Painting ●○○
29 Balloon Volleyball ●○○
31 Shadow Theater ●●○
41 Finger Painting ●○○
43 Clay Sculpting ●●○
51 Chair Yoga Flow ●○○
55 Seated March Along ●○○
59 Ball Pass Circle ●○○
63 Beanbag Toss ●○○
66 Ribbon Dance ●○○
70 Finger Gym ●○○
74 Wheelchair Bowling ●○○
78 Seated Tai Chi ●●○
81 Good Morning Stretch ●○○
84 Walk & Talk Club ●●○
88 Paper Plate Frisbee ●○○
92 Hot Potato ●○○
95 Seated Simon Says ●○○
99 Cup Stacking Challenge ●●○
102 Pool Noodle Hockey ●●○
106 Kitchen Dance Party ●○○
109 Balloon Tennis ●○○
113 Button Sorting ●○○
117 Lacing Cards ●●○
120 Bead a Bracelet ●●○
123 Easy Paper Folding ●●○
127 Finger Knitting ●●●
131 Bubble Fun ●○○
135 Tabletop Mini Golf ●●○
138 Weave a Placemat ●●○
142 Seated Drum Circle ●○○
146 Towel Stretch ●○○
150 Clothespin Challenge ●●○

Choose by goal, pick the right level — and enjoy!

FAMILY CONNECTION

Stories, traditions and moments that bring generations together.



LEVEL ●○○ Easy ●●○ Medium ●●● Challenging

35 activities

1 The Memory Jar ●○○
5 A Recipe to Remember ●○○
11 Life Story Bingo ●○○
13 Letters from the Heart ●●○
23 Family Photo Puzzle ●●○
36 The Memory Phone Call ●○○
46 Memory Scrapbook ●●○
47 My Favorite Things ●○○
48 Thanksgiving Memories ●○○
52 My Family Tree ●●○
56 Grandchild Interview ●○○
60 Recreate an Old Photo ●○○
64 Baking Grandma's Cookies ●○○
68 The Story of My Name ●○○
71 My First Car ●○○
75 Wedding Day Memories ●○○
79 Christmas Memories ●○○
83 Fourth of July Picnic ●○○
87 Valentine Love Notes ●○○
90 Easter Egg Decorating ●○○
94 Pumpkin Painting ●○○
98 Birthday Memory Book ●●○
103 Letter to Future Generations ●●○
107 Video Call Show & Tell ●○○
110 Family Checkers Night ●●○
114 Grandparent Advice Cards ●○○
118 Map of My Life ●●○
122 Hometown Memories ●○○
126 Teach Me Your Skill ●●○
130 Family Sing-Along ●○○
133 Pets We've Loved ●○○
137 School Days ●○○
141 Handmade Greeting Cards ●●○
145 Family Photo Wall ●●○
149 Thank-You Letters ●●○

Choose by goal, pick the right level — and enjoy!

MOOD & WELL-BEING

Laughter, calm and small joys that brighten every single day.



LEVEL ●○○ Easy ●●○ Medium ●●● Challenging

35 activities

3 The Senses Box ●○○
7 Name That Tune ●○○
9 The Gratitude Tree ●○○
16 Garden Mandala ●○○
17 What's That Sound? ●○○
20 Build-a-Sundae Social ●○○
25 Balloon Breathing ●○○
27 Tastes of Life ●○○
33 Homemade Aromatherapy ●○○
34 Color Dominoes ●●○
38 Dream Board ●●○
40 Color Race ●○○
44 Guided Meditation ●○○
50 Hand Spa Day ●○○
54 The Joke Jar ●○○
58 Laughter Yoga ●○○
62 Afternoon Tea Party ●○○
67 Backyard Bird Watching ●○○
72 Sock Puppet Show ●●○
77 Nature Scavenger Hunt ●○○
82 Karaoke Classics ●○○
86 Movie Afternoon ●○○
91 Warm Foot Soak ●○○
96 Watercolor Postcards ●●○
101 Pet Therapy Visit ●○○
105 Coloring Page: Country Barn ●○○
111 Coloring Page: By the Sea ●○○
115 Riddle Time ●●○
119 Magnetic Fishing Game ●○○
124 Silly Hat Parade ●○○
129 Sunshine Break ●○○
134 Positive Words Cards ●○○
139 Funny Captions ●●○
143 Aquarium Calm ●○○
147 Bubble Wrap Pop ●○○

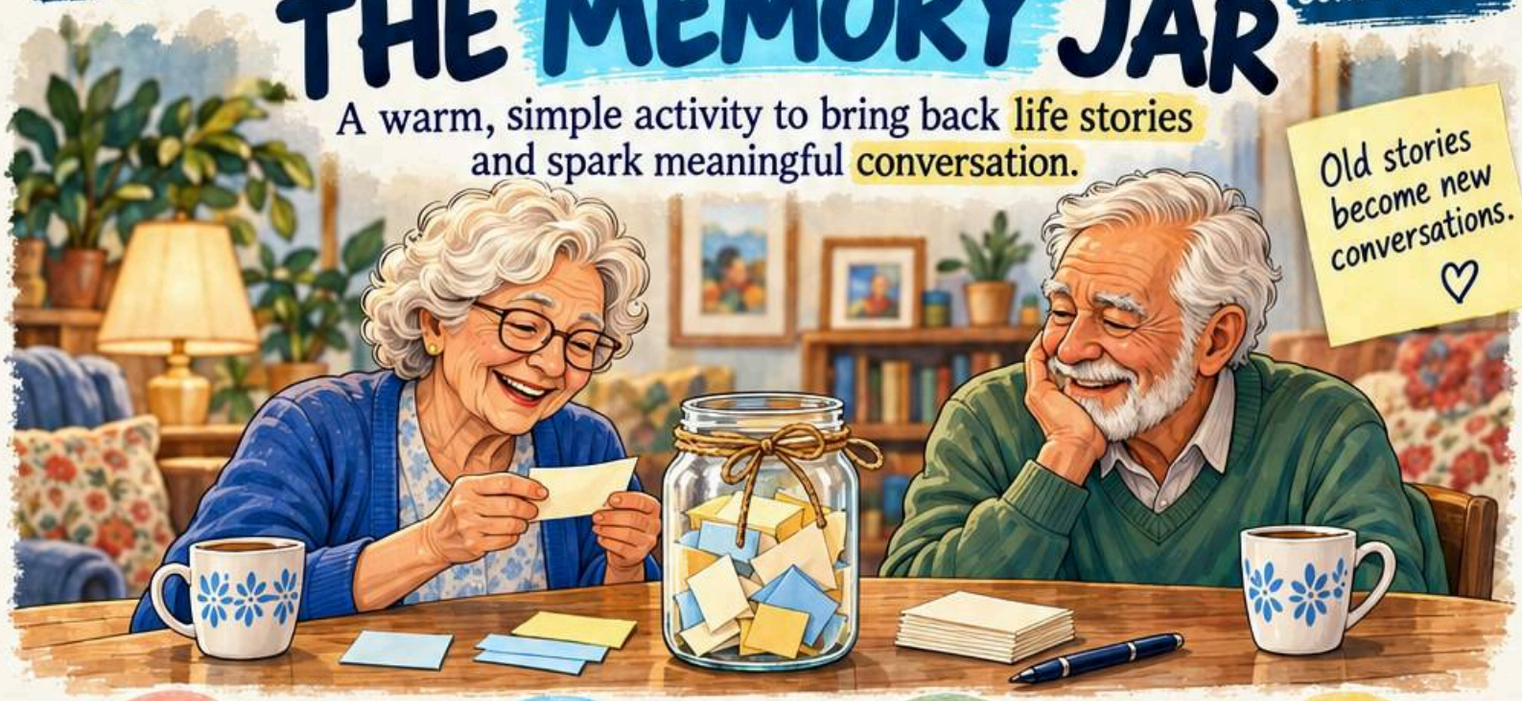
Choose by goal, pick the right level — and enjoy!

ACTIVITY 01

MEMORY & CONVERSATION

THE MEMORY JAR

A warm, simple activity to bring back life stories and spark meaningful conversation.



- Recall life memories
- Encourage conversation
- Strengthen emotional bonds
- Build confidence

MATERIALS NEEDED



1 glass jar or box



Paper slips



Pen



A quiet, cozy spot

STEP BY STEP



1 PREPARE THE JAR
Write simple questions on slips of paper. Fold them and drop them into the jar.



2 PICK A SLIP
Invite the person to draw one slip and read it aloud, or read it for them.



3 SHARE THE STORY
Listen with genuine interest. Let the memory unfold at its own pace.



4 KEEP IT GOING
Ask gentle follow-ups: "Who was with you?" "What did it smell like?"

QUESTION IDEAS

- What was your first job?
- Tell me about your wedding day.
- What song always makes you dance?
- Describe the house you grew up in.
- What was your favorite family recipe?

CAREGIVER TIP

There are no right or wrong answers. If a question brings up sadness, slow down, listen, and gently pick a lighter slip.



MAKE IT EASIER:
Use photos instead of written questions.

MAKE IT HARDER:
Ask for three details: who, where and when.

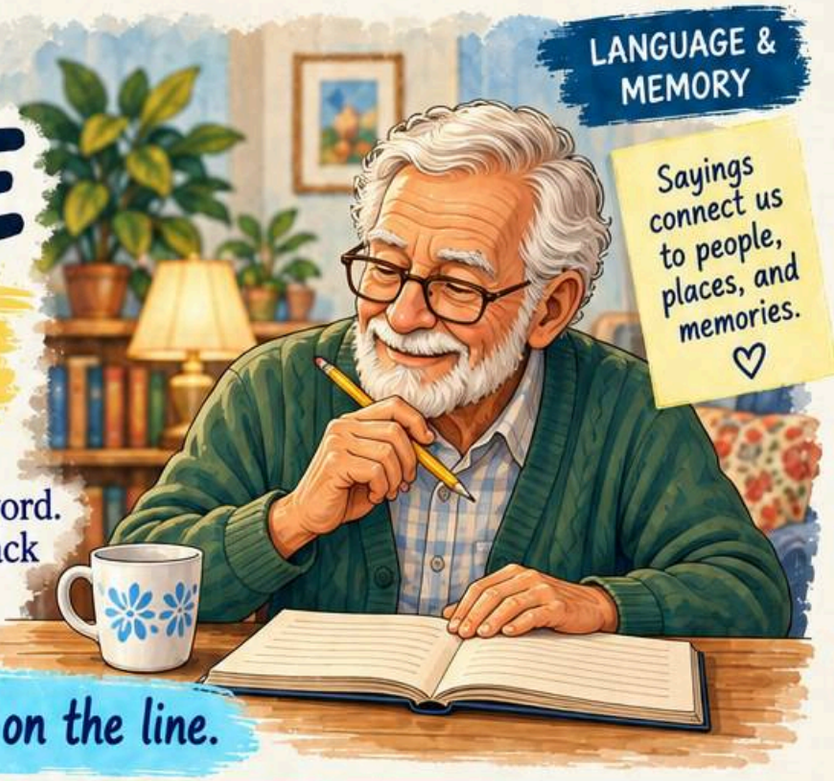


"Every story shared is a memory kept alive."

ACTIVITY 02

LANGUAGE & MEMORY

FINISH THE SAYING



Sayings connect us to people, places, and memories. ♡

Classic American sayings with a missing word. Take your time — the words often come back on their own.

Write the missing word on the line.

1. An apple a day keeps the _____ away.
2. The early bird catches the _____.
3. Don't count your chickens before they _____.
4. Actions speak louder than _____.
5. Every cloud has a silver _____.
6. Better late than _____.
7. A penny saved is a penny _____.
8. Home is where the _____ is.
9. Rome wasn't built in a _____.
10. There's no place like _____.

WHY THIS HELPS

- Word retrieval
- Long-term memory
- A quick sense of success

CAREGIVER TIP

Read the saying aloud with rhythm. Often the last word comes out naturally.

ANSWERS: doctor · worm · fetch · words · lining · never · earned · heart · day · home

ACTIVITY 03

THE SENSES BOX

SENSES & RECOGNITION



Touch, smell and guess – a gentle way to awaken the senses and spark memories.

- Sensory stimulation
- Object recognition
- Descriptive language
- Relaxed focus

MATERIALS NEEDED



Shoebox with a hole in the lid



Small familiar objects



Soft cloth

WHAT TO PUT INSIDE



Pinecone



Cinnamon stick



Soft scarf



Lemon



Wooden spoon



Seashell

HOW TO PLAY

1



FILL THE BOX

Place one safe, familiar object inside.

2



TOUCH

Ask the person to feel it without looking.

3



DESCRIBE & GUESS

Soft or rough? Warm or cool? What could it be?

4



REMEMBER

Reveal it and ask, "Where have you seen this before?"

CAREGIVER TIP

Avoid sharp, tiny or strong-smelling items.
Let the person peek if guessing feels stressful.

ACTIVITY 04

ATTENTION & FOCUS

SAY THE COLOR!

A playful brain challenge: say the ink color, not the word you read.



EXAMPLE:

BLUE → Say "red" — not "blue".

RED	GREEN	BLUE	ORANGE
BLUE	RED	ORANGE	GREEN
GREEN	ORANGE	RED	BLUE
ORANGE	BLUE	GREEN	RED
RED	GREEN	BLUE	ORANGE

TRY IT 3 WAYS

1. Read the words.
2. Say the colors.
3. Say the colors faster.

CAREGIVER TIP

Start slowly. Laughing at the mix-ups is part of the fun.

ACTIVITY 05

RECOLLECTION & CONVERSATION

A RECIPE TO REMEMBER

Every family has a dish with a story.
Write it down together before it fades.



RECIPE NAME: _____

WHO MADE IT: _____

WHEN WE ATE IT: _____

INGREDIENTS:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____
6. _____

HOW IT WAS MADE:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____

TALK ABOUT IT

Who taught you this recipe?



What did the kitchen smell like?



Was it for a holiday or every Sunday?



Who always asked for seconds?



CAREGIVER TIP

Exact amounts don't matter. The story behind the dish matters most. Cooking it together later is a wonderful bonus.

"Some memories are best served warm." ♡

ACTIVITY 06

NUMBERS & REASONING

NUMBER GYM



Warm up your mind with friendly everyday math. No calculators, no hurry.

A QUICK ADDITION

Add the numbers. Write your answer in the box.

4 + 3 = ☐

8 + 5 = ☐

12 + 6 = ☐

15 + 10 = ☐

B AT THE STORE

Look at the prices. Solve the problems. Write your answer in the box.



Milk $3 + Bread $2 = ☐

Apples $5 + Coffee $4 = ☐

You pay $10 for a $7 item. Change: ☐

C WHAT COMES NEXT?

Look at the number patterns. Write the next number in the box.

2, 4, 6, 8, ☐

5, 10, 15, 20, ☐

30, 25, 20, 15, ☐

D CLOCK MATH

Use the clocks to solve the problems. Write your answer in the box.



It is 2:00. In 3 hours it will be ☐.



Lunch is at 12:00. It is 11:30. Minutes to wait: ☐

WHY THIS HELPS

- Keeps calculation skills active
- Supports daily independence
- Builds confidence

Saying the numbers aloud helps.

ACTIVITY 07

MUSIC & MEMORY

NAME THAT TUNE

Music unlocks memories words can't reach.
Play a few notes and watch the stories come back.

WHAT YOU NEED



Phone, tablet or radio



A list of songs



Paper to keep score (optional)



HOW TO PLAY

1. Play the first 10 seconds of a song.
2. Ask: "What's the song? Who sang it?"
3. Hum or sing along together.
4. Ask: "Where were you when this song was popular?"

SONG IDEAS











BENEFITS

- Long-term memory
- Mood and joy
- Group connection

CAREGIVER TIP

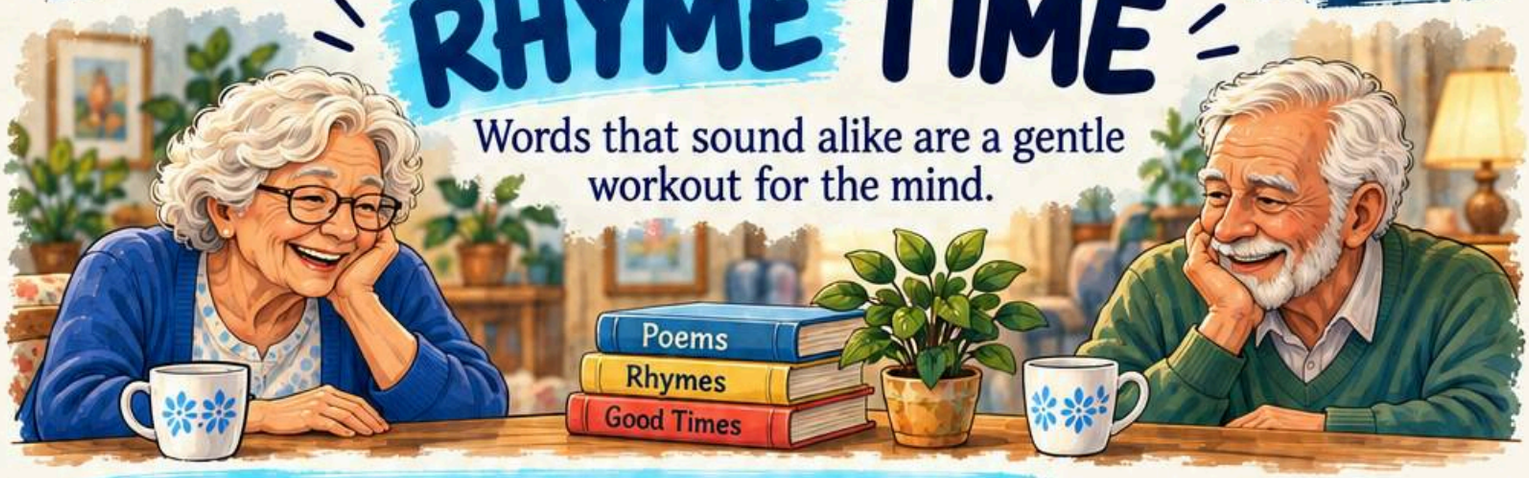
Choose songs from when the person was 15 to 30 years old. That's where musical memories are strongest.

ACTIVITY 08

WORDS & SOUNDS

RHYME TIME

Words that sound alike are a gentle workout for the mind.



PART 1 — DRAW A LINE TO THE RHYME

	CAT	•	•  TRAIN
	BOOK	•	•  BLUE
	RAIN	•	•  CAR
	STAR	•	•  HAT
	BELL	•	•  SHELL
	SHOE	•	•  COOK

PART 2 — FINISH THE RHYME

1. The sun is high, up in the _____.
2. I found my key under the _____.
3. Time for a nap, I'll wear my _____.

CAREGIVER TIP

Any word that rhymes is a good answer. Say the words out loud together.

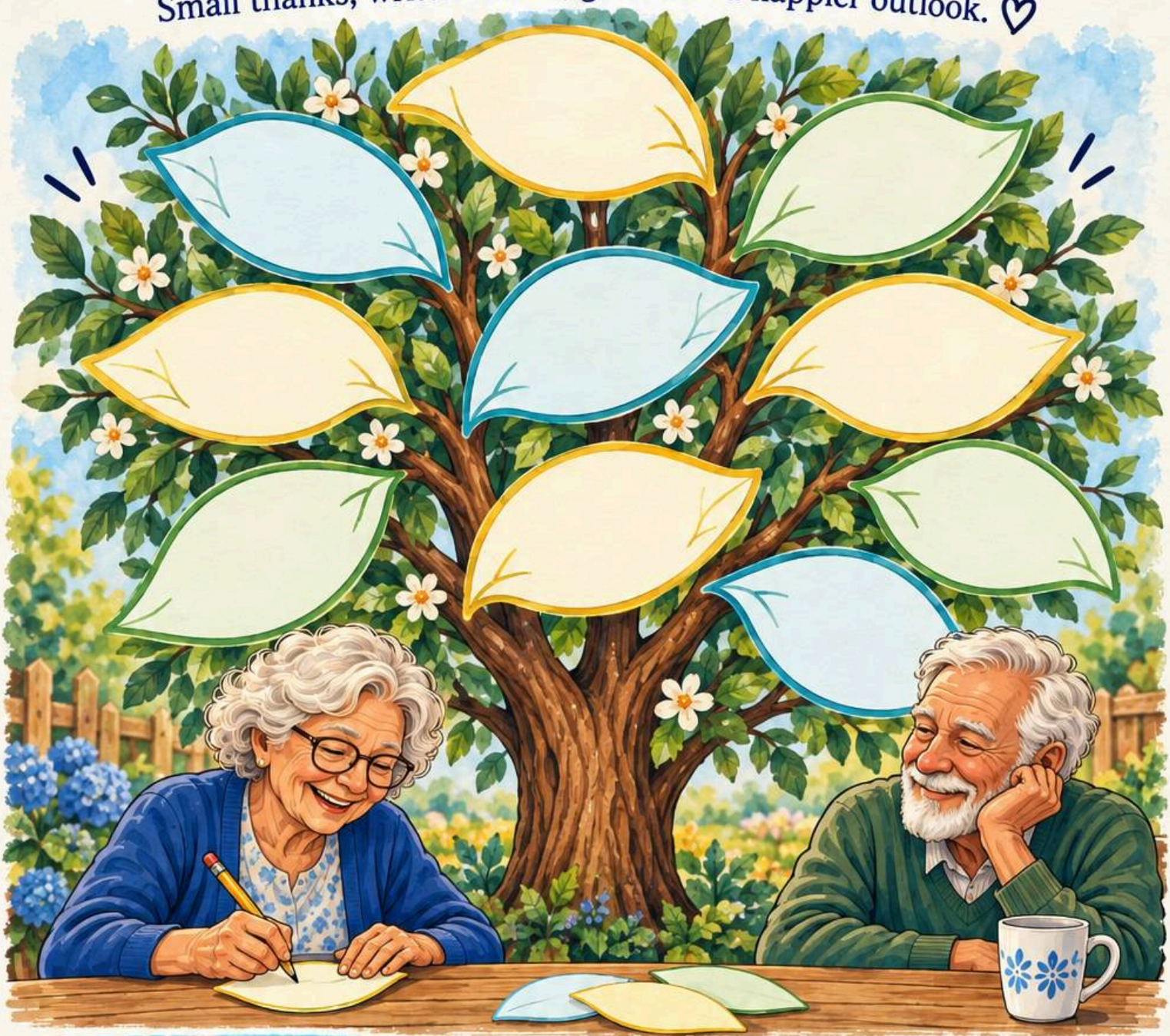


ACTIVITY 09

EMOTIONAL WELL-BEING

THE GRATITUDE TREE

Small thanks, written down, grow into a happier outlook. ♡



HOW TO DO IT

1. Think of something good — big or small.
2. Write it on a leaf.
3. Share it with someone nearby.
4. Add a new leaf every day.

NEED AN IDEA?



A person who makes me smile



A favorite place



Something I'm good at

CAREGIVER TIP

Write for the person if holding a pencil is hard. Their words, your handwriting.

Gratitude turns what we have into enough. ♡

ACTIVITY 10

SHAPE SUDOKU

No numbers — just shapes. Fill the board using simple logic.

RULES



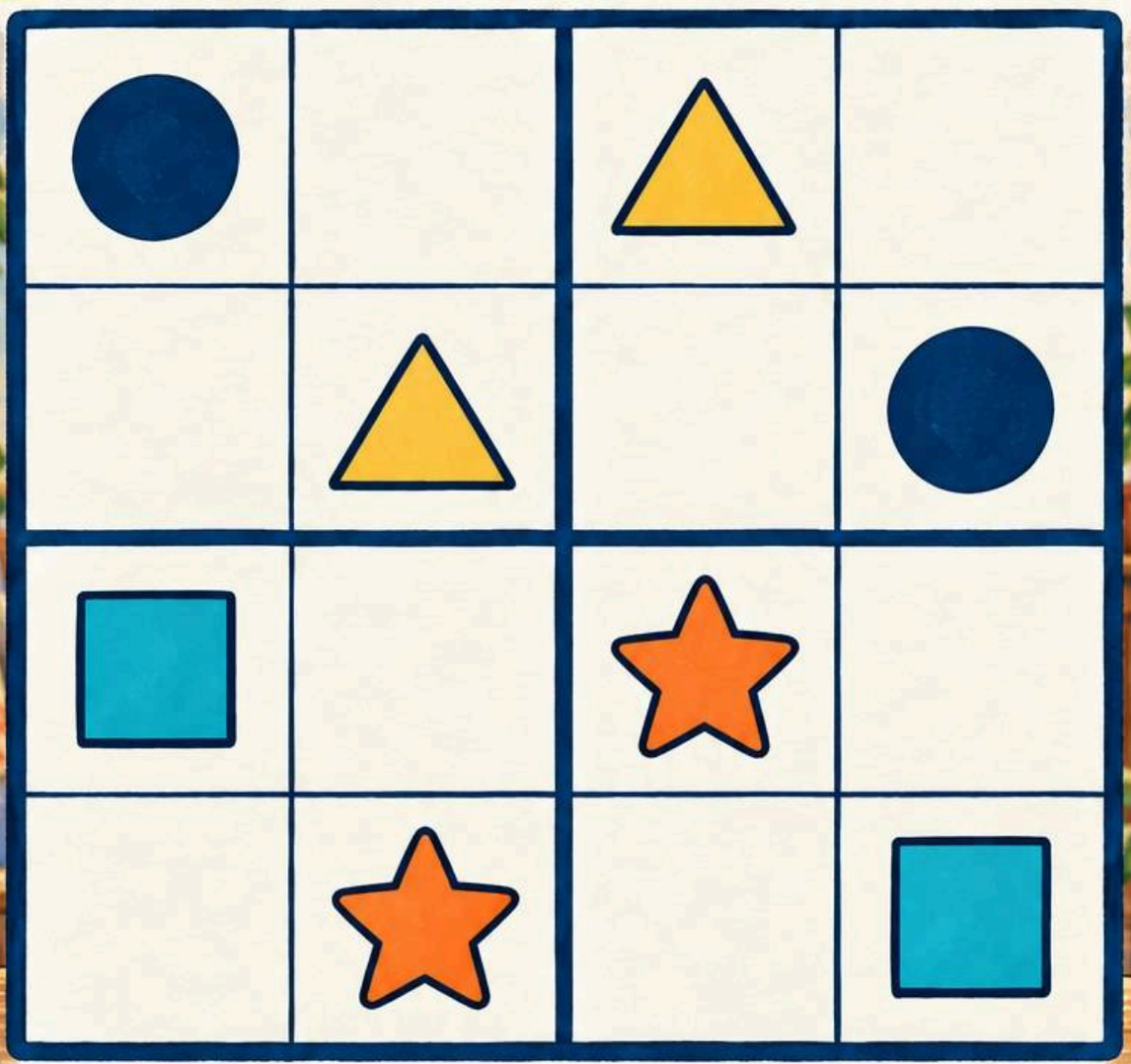
Each **ROW** has all 4 shapes.



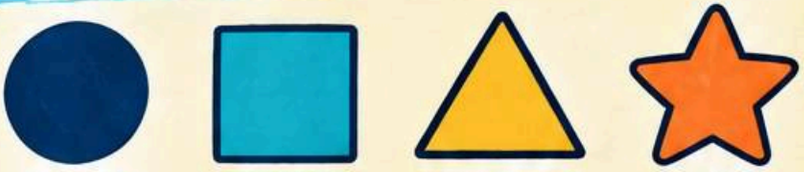
Each **COLUMN** has all 4 shapes.



Each **2x2 BOX** has all 4 shapes.



THE SHAPES



CIRCLE SQUARE TRIANGLE STAR

CAREGIVER TIP

Start with the row that has the most shapes. Drawing a simple outline is enough.



ACTIVITY 11

SOCIAL & REMINISCENCE

LIFE STORY BINGO

Classic bingo with a twist: every square is a chance to share a story.



B	I	N	G	O
Rode a horse	Learned to drive	Met a celebrity	Grew a garden	Played an instrument
Lived on a farm	Went to a drive-in	Baked a pie	Traveled by train	Saw the ocean
Had a pen pal	Sang in a choir	FREE	Owned a dog	Danced at a wedding
Caught a fish	Went to a fair	Wrote a love letter	Flew in a plane	Built something
Lived in a big city	Won a prize	Had a first job before 16	Camped outdoors	Rode a bicycle to school

HOW TO PLAY

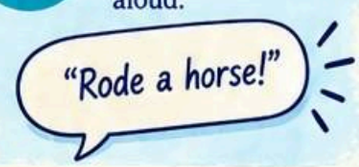
1 GIVE CARDS

One card and a few markers per person.



2 CALL A SQUARE

Read one phrase aloud.



3 SHARE & MARK

Anyone who did it marks the square and tells the story.



4 BINGO!

Five in a row wins. Celebrate every story!



MATERIALS NEEDED



Bingo cards



Buttons or coins as markers



A small prize

CAREGIVER TIP

The stories matter more than the win. Give every player a moment to speak.

SOCK HOP WORD SEARCH



Put on your dancing shoes! Find these 1950s favorites hidden across and down.

S	I	C	P	E	N	S	I	Y	N	L
O	W	A	O	M	H	J	E	C	F	E
C	H	D	O	W	H	U	H	A	P	T
K	F	I	D	I	J	K	U	D	A	E
H	N	L	L	S	L	E	L	R	U	T
O	K	L	E	E	Y	B	A	I	E	R
P	U	A	V	W	B	O	H	V	L	O
W	S	C	M	M	M	X	O	E	V	M
D	D	I	N	E	R	P	O	I	I	V
R	E	C	O	R	D	M	P	N	S	B
G	C	M	I	L	K	S	H	A	K	E

Words go across → and down ↓ only. ♡



WORD LIST



JUKEBOX



DINER



POODLE



RECORD



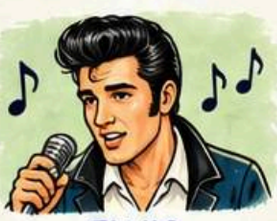
MILKSHAKE



HULA HOOP



SOCK HOP



ELVIS



CADILLAC



DRIVE-IN

ACTIVITY 13

EMOTIONS & CONNECTION

LETTERS FROM THE HEART



Some words are easier to write than to say. A letter keeps them forever.

Dear _____,

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

With love, _____

WHO COULD YOU WRITE TO?


A grandchild


An old friend


Your younger self

HOW TO DO IT

1 **CHOOSE SOMEONE**
Think of a person you'd love to reach.

SHARE A MEMORY
Start with a moment you shared.

SEND IT
Mail it, hand it over, or keep it in a memory box.

MATERIALS NEEDED


Nice paper

Pen


Envelope & stamp

CAREGIVER TIP

Offer to write while the person speaks. Read it back so they can add a final touch.

"A letter is a hug you can hold."

GOLDEN AGE MOVIE TRIVIA

Grab the popcorn! How many classics do you remember?

1 Who sang 'Over the Rainbow' in *The Wizard of Oz*?



- ◯ A) Judy Garland
- ◯ B) Doris Day
- ◯ C) Shirley Temple

2 Which movie has the line 'Here's looking at you, kid'?



- ◯ A) *Gone with the Wind*
- ◯ B) Casablanca
- ◯ C) Roman Holiday

3 Who danced in *'Singin' in the Rain'*?



- ◯ A) Fred Astaire
- ◯ B) Elvis Presley
- ◯ C) Gene Kelly

4 Which star played Holly Golightly in *'Breakfast at Tiffany's'*?



- ◯ A) Audrey Hepburn
- ◯ B) Grace Kelly
- ◯ C) Marilyn Monroe

5 In *'It's a Wonderful Life'*, who is George Bailey's guardian angel?



- ◯ A) Gabriel
- ◯ B) Clarence
- ◯ C) Henry

6 Which Disney film features the song *'When You Wish Upon a Star'*?



- ◯ A) Cinderella
- ◯ B) Bambi
- ◯ C) Pinocchio



CAREGIVER TIP

Use these questions as a starting point for conversation. Ask what other favorite movies or stars they remember!

ANSWERS: 1-A · 2-B · 3-C · 4-A · 5-B · 6-C

ACTIVITY 15

MOVEMENT & MUSIC

SEATED HAND DANCE

Rhythm, laughter and gentle movement — all without leaving the chair.

MOVE 1
CLAP THE BEAT

Clap along with the rhythm.



MOVE 2
ROLL THE HANDS

Roll your hands forward, then backward.

MOVE 3
WAVE HELLO



Wave the scarf high, then low.

WHAT YOU NEED



Upbeat music

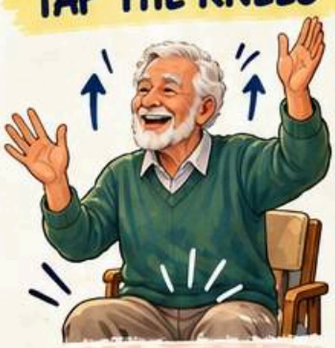


Light scarves



Sturdy chairs

MOVE 4
TAP THE KNEES



Tap your knees, then reach up to the sky.

BENEFITS

- Coordination
- Circulation
- Good mood
- Group fun

CAREGIVER TIP

Follow the slowest mover's pace. Any movement counts — even just smiling along.

"Music and movement bring people together at any age."

ACTIVITY 16

CREATIVITY & CALM

GARDEN MANDALA

Relax, breathe and bring this garden to life with your favorite colors.

COLOR IDEAS

CAREGIVER TIP

There is no wrong color. Go slowly and enjoy each petal.



BENEFITS

- Relaxation
- Focus
- Fine motor skills

ACTIVITY 17

LISTENING & MEMORY

WHAT'S THAT SOUND?



Close your eyes and listen.
Every sound can carry a memory.

SOUND IDEAS



Doorbell



Rooster



Train whistle



Rain



Ocean waves



Church bells



Popcorn popping



Old telephone ring

HOW TO PLAY

1 PLAY A SOUND
Use a phone, tablet or speaker.



2 GUESS
What do you think it is?



3 REMEMBER
Where have you heard this before?



MATERIALS NEEDED



Phone or tablet



Speaker (optional)

CAREGIVER TIP

Keep the volume comfortable.
Give hints if needed — the conversation is the real prize.

THEN & NOW

Times change! Draw a line from each old favorite to its modern version.

THEN	NOW
Rotary phone 	 Music app on a phone
Typewriter 	 Refrigerator
Record player 	 GPS on a phone
Film camera 	 Laptop
Paper map 	 Digital camera
Ice box 	 Cell phone

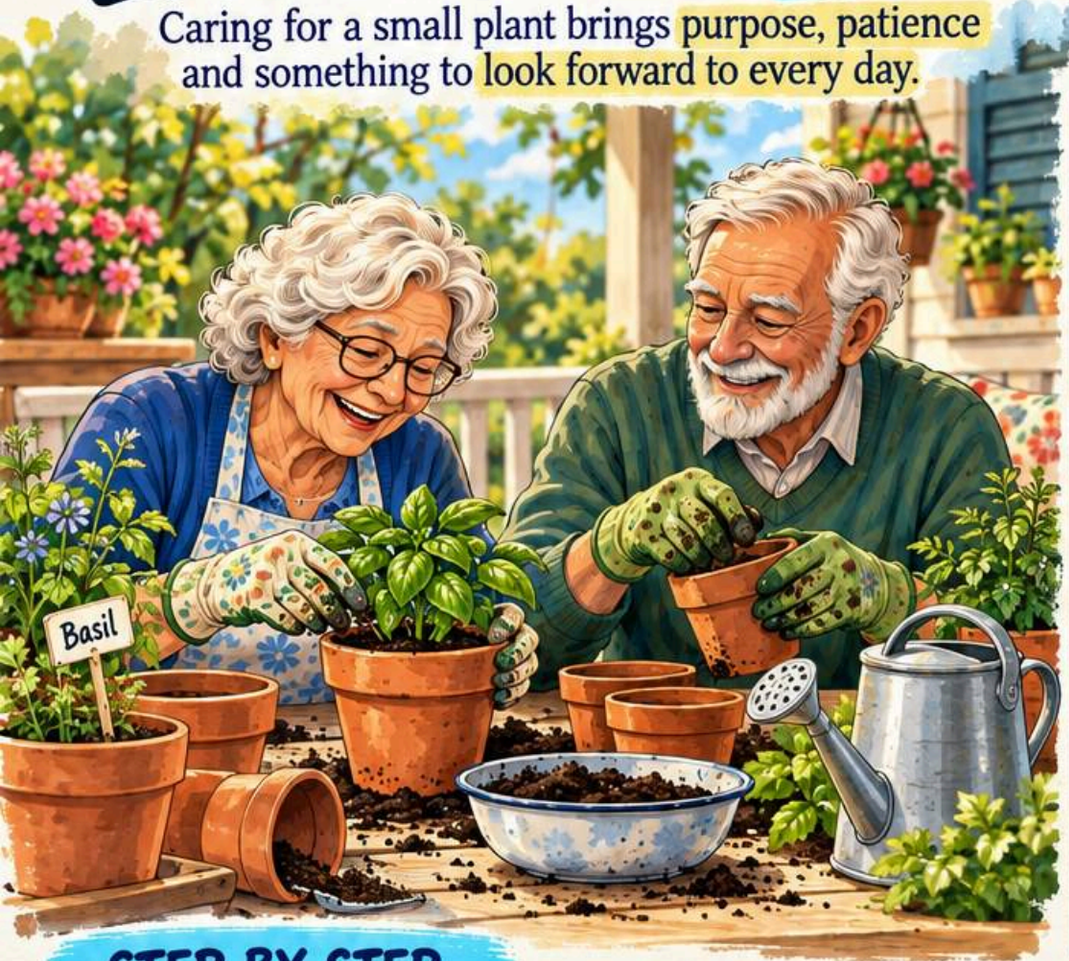


TALK ABOUT IT

- Which one did you use the most?
- What do you miss about the old days?

LITTLE POT GARDEN

Caring for a small plant brings purpose, patience and something to look forward to every day.



MATERIALS NEEDED



Small pots



Potting soil



Seeds or seedlings



Watering can



Gloves

STEP BY STEP

1 FILL
Add soil to the pot.



2 PLANT
Press in seeds or a small plant.



3 WATER
Give it a gentle drink.



4 WATCH IT GROW
Check on it every morning.



EASY PLANTS TO START



Basil



Mint



Marigolds



Cherry tomatoes

CAREGIVER TIP

Use a table at seated height and lightweight tools. Let the person choose the plant.

"Every sprout is a small piece of hope." ♡

ACTIVITY 20

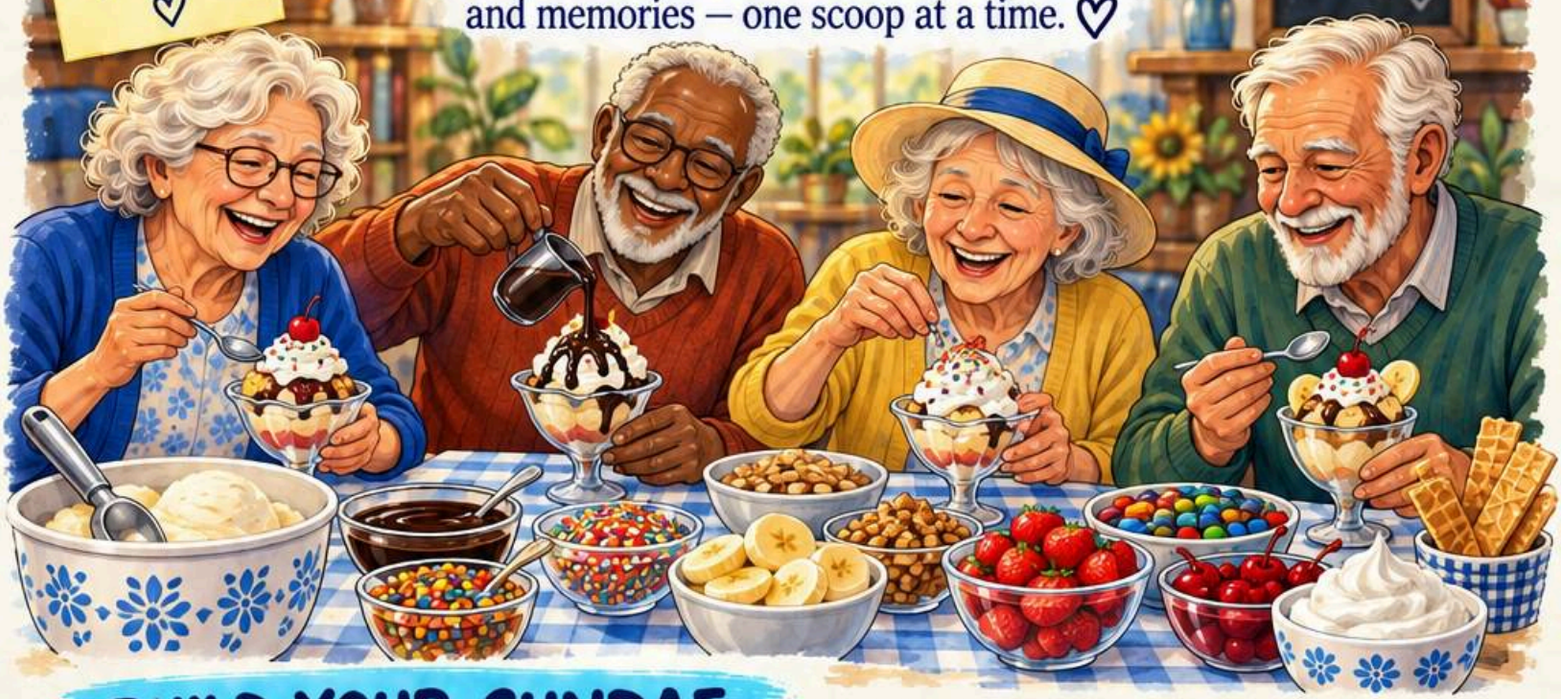
SOCIAL & SENSES

BUILD-A-SUNDAE SOCIAL

A sweet afternoon of choices, laughter and memories — one scoop at a time. ♡

Ice cream brings out the sweetest memories. ♡

Good Friends Sweeter Days ♡



BUILD YOUR SUNDAE



Vanilla ice cream



Chocolate sauce



Sprinkles



Sliced bananas



Whipped cream



A cherry on top

HOW TO HOST

1 SET THE TABLE
Put out bowls, spoons and toppings.



2 CHOOSE
Let each person pick their favorites.



3 SHARE STORIES
Talk while you enjoy.



LET'S TALK

What was your favorite ice cream as a child?

Where did you go for a treat on a hot day?



CAREGIVER TIP

Check for diets and allergies first. Sugar-free options work just as well.

ACTIVITY 21

CREATIVITY & EXPRESSION

SPONGE PAINTING

No drawing skills needed — just dab, press and watch beautiful art appear.



MATERIALS NEEDED

Kitchen sponges cut in shapes



Washable paint



Thick paper



Paper plates



Wet wipes



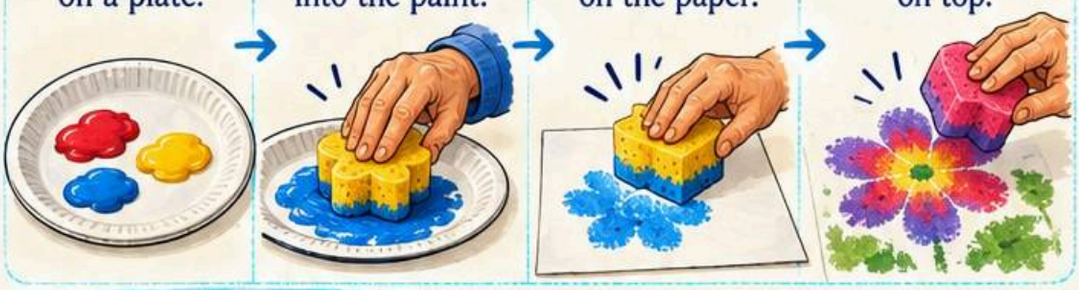
STEP BY STEP

1 POUR
A little paint on a plate.

2 DAB
Press the sponge into the paint.

3 STAMP
Press it gently on the paper.

4 LAYER
Add new colors on top.



IDEAS TO TRY



Autumn tree

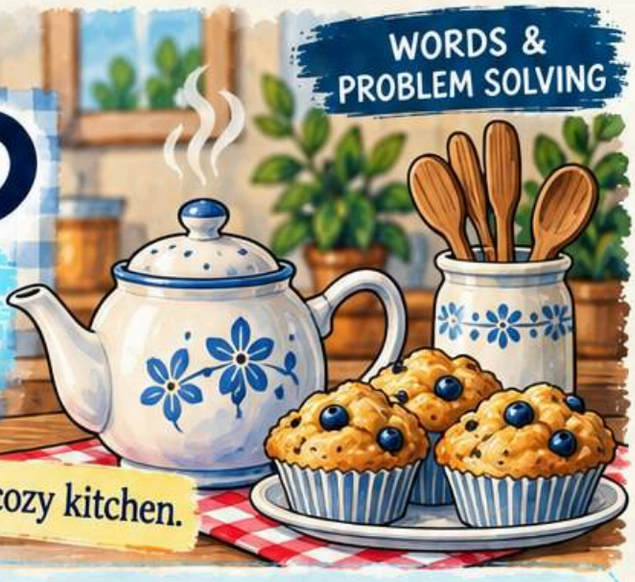
Sunset sky

Garden flowers

CAREGIVER TIP

Cut sponges into large, easy-to-hold shapes. Celebrate every finished piece and hang it up!

KITCHEN WORD SCRAMBLE



Unscramble the letters to find things you'd see in a cozy kitchen.

1 N O O P S



_ _ _ _ _ _

2 T L E K E T



_ _ _ _ _ _

3 N O R P A



_ _ _ _ _

4 N E V O



_ _ _ _ _

5 T E L P A



_ _ _ _ _

6 F U N M I F



_ _ _ _ _

7 T E R B U T



_ _ _ _ _

8 F E C O F E



_ _ _ _ _

CAREGIVER TIP

Look at the picture hint first. Saying the letters aloud often unlocks the word.

ANSWERS:

SPOON · KETTLE · APRON · OVEN · PLATE · MUFFIN · BUTTER · COFFEE

ACTIVITY 23

MEMORY & FAMILY

FAMILY PHOTO PUZZLE

Turn a favorite family photo into a puzzle — and rebuild a memory piece by piece.



HOW TO MAKE IT

1 PRINT

Enlarge a family photo and print it.

2 GLUE

Stick it on cardboard.



3 CUT

Cut into 6 to 12 big pieces.



4 ASSEMBLE

Put it together and talk about it.



MATERIALS NEEDED



Family photo · Cardboard · Glue stick · Scissors

BENEFITS

- Visual reasoning
- Long-term memory
- Family connection

TALK ABOUT IT

- Who is in this photo?
- Where was it taken?
- What happened that day?

CAREGIVER TIP

Start with 6 large pieces. Keep the original photo nearby as a guide.

ACTIVITY 24

REASONING & CATEGORIES

ODD ONE OUT

Look at each row. Circle the one that doesn't belong – then say why!



Circle it. Then tell someone why it's different.

1  (fruit)

2  (animals)

3  (musical instruments)

4  (clothing)

5  (flowers)

6  (transportation)

CAREGIVER TIP

There can be more than one good answer. Ask 'Why?' and enjoy the reasoning.

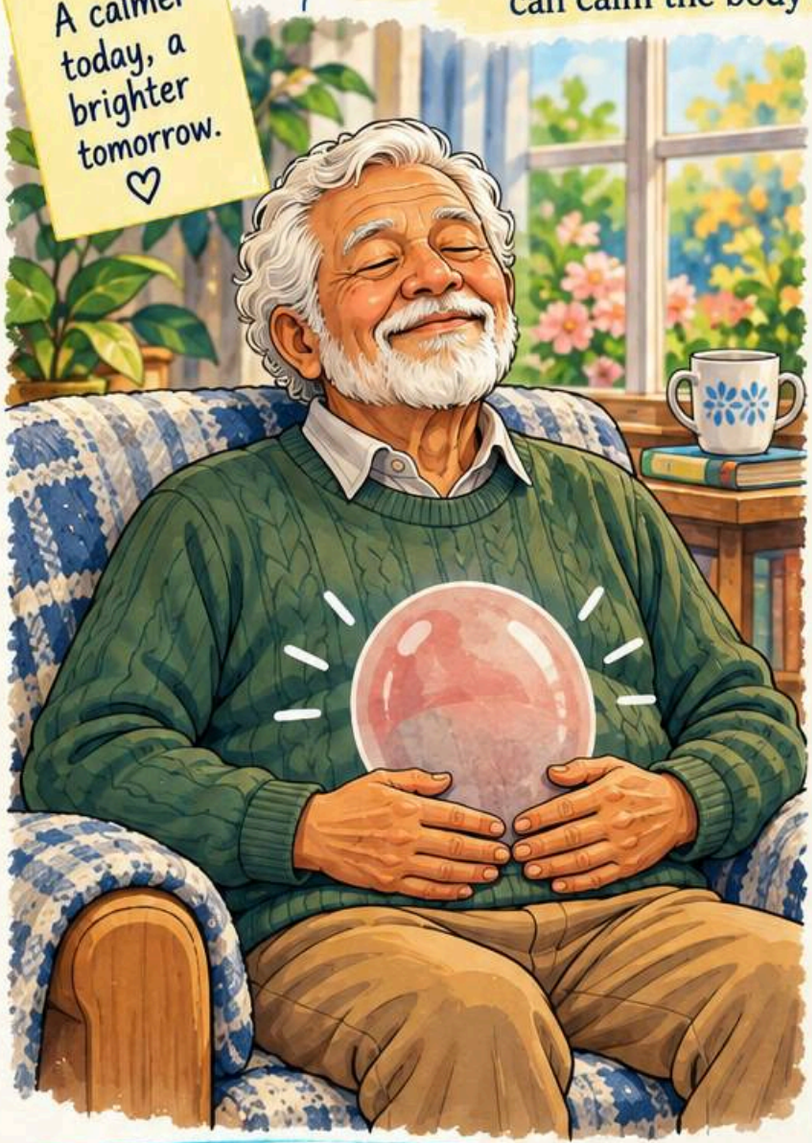
ACTIVITY 25

RELAXATION & BREATHING

BALLOON BREATHING

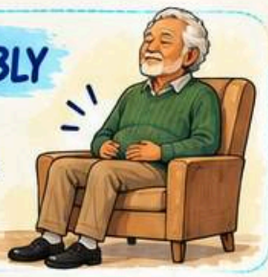
Imagine a balloon in your belly. A few slow breaths can calm the body and the mind.

A calmer today, a brighter tomorrow. ♡



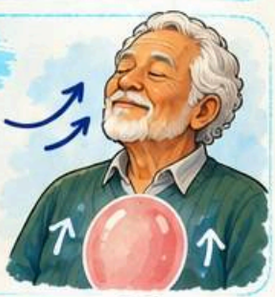
1 SIT COMFORTABLY

Feet flat, shoulders relaxed.



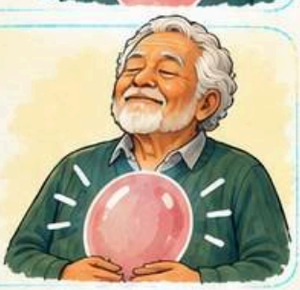
2 BREATHE IN

Slowly through the nose. Feel the balloon fill.



3 PAUSE

Hold gently for a moment.



4 BREATHE OUT

Slowly through the mouth. Let the balloon float away.



COUNT WITH ME



IN

1 · 2 · 3 · 4



OUT

1 · 2 · 3 · 4 · 5 · 6

BENEFITS

- Reduces stress
- Better sleep
- Calm focus

CAREGIVER TIP

Breathe together and keep it gentle. Stop if the person feels dizzy.

“Breathe in calm, breathe out worry. ♡

NAME FIVE!

How many can you name? Write five things for each category.

Want a challenge? Try it with a 1-minute timer!



FRUITS



1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____

THINGS AT THE BEACH



1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____

U.S. STATES



1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____

THINGS IN A GARDEN



1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____

BREAKFAST FOODS



1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____

MUSICAL INSTRUMENTS



1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____

CAREGIVER TIP

Give hints with first letters if needed. Every answer counts.



TASTES OF LIFE

A tiny taste can open a door to a big memory.





STEPS

1 PREPARE
Offer small tastes on spoons.



2 TASTE
Eyes closed (optional).



3 GUESS
Sweet, sour, spicy? What is it?



4 REMEMBER
When did you taste this as a child?



LET'S TALK

What did your mother cook on Sundays?



What treat did you love at the county fair?



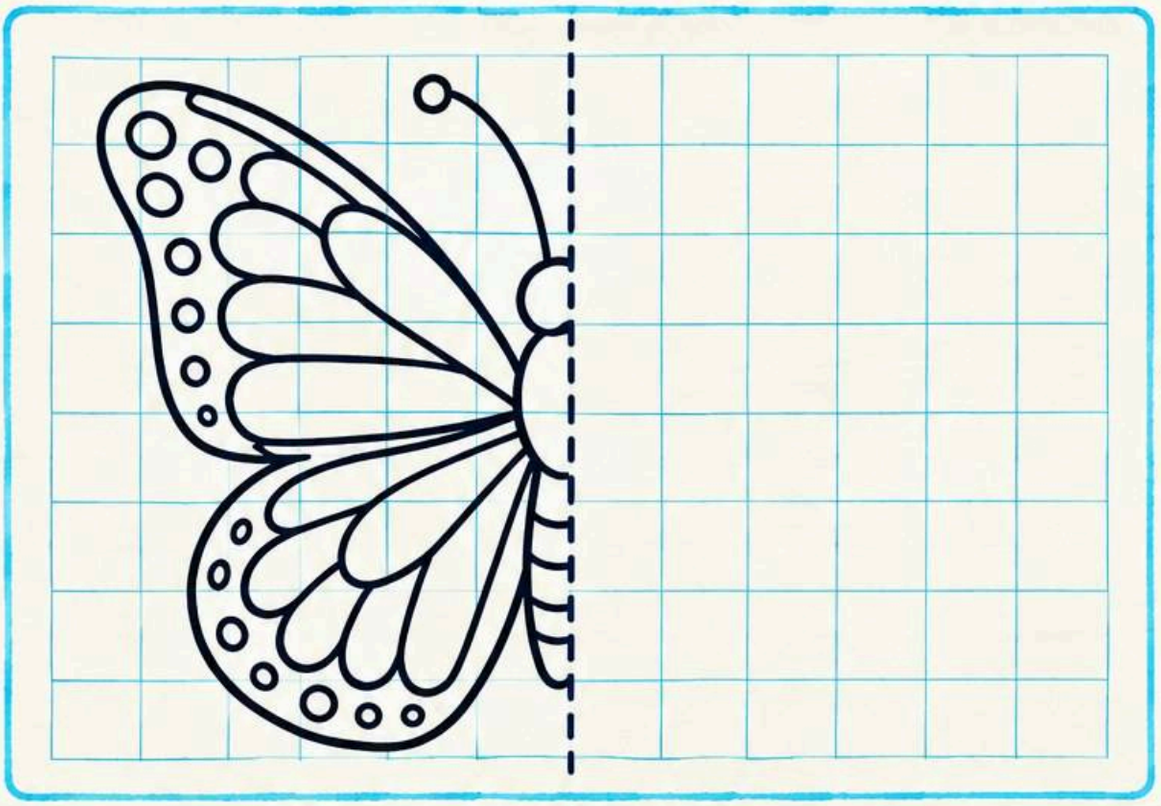
CAREGIVER TIP



Always check swallowing safety, diets and allergies first. Tiny portions are enough.

FINISH THE PICTURE

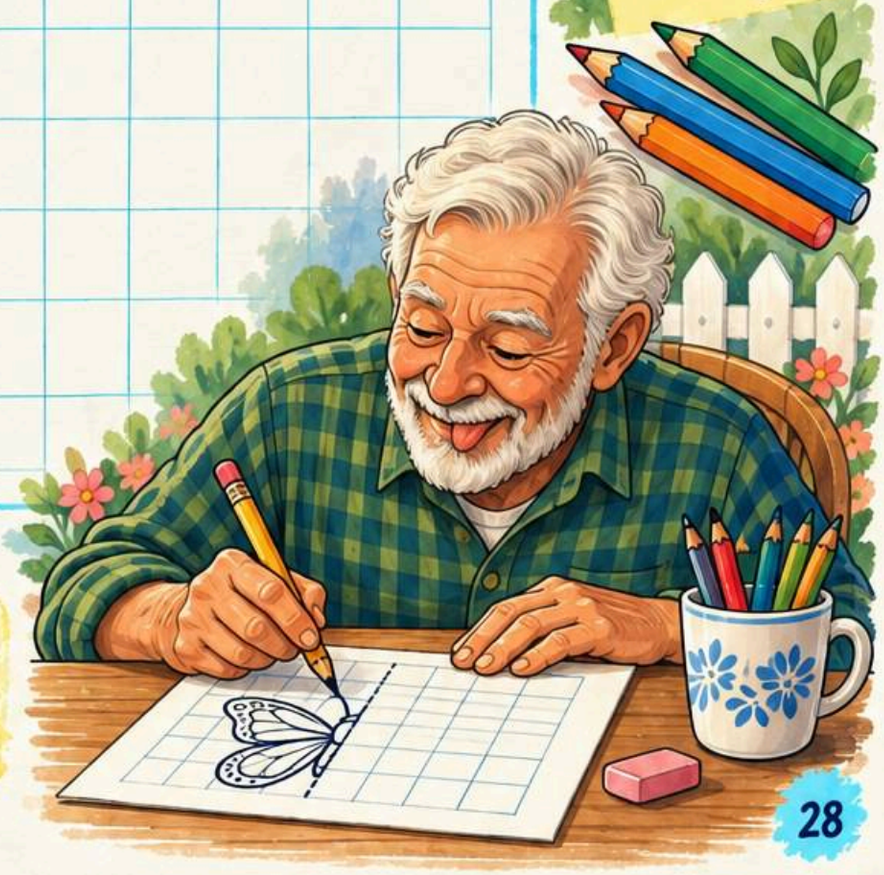
Use the grid squares as a guide and draw the missing half.



Count the squares — it's like a mirror!



Color it in if you like!



CAREGIVER TIP

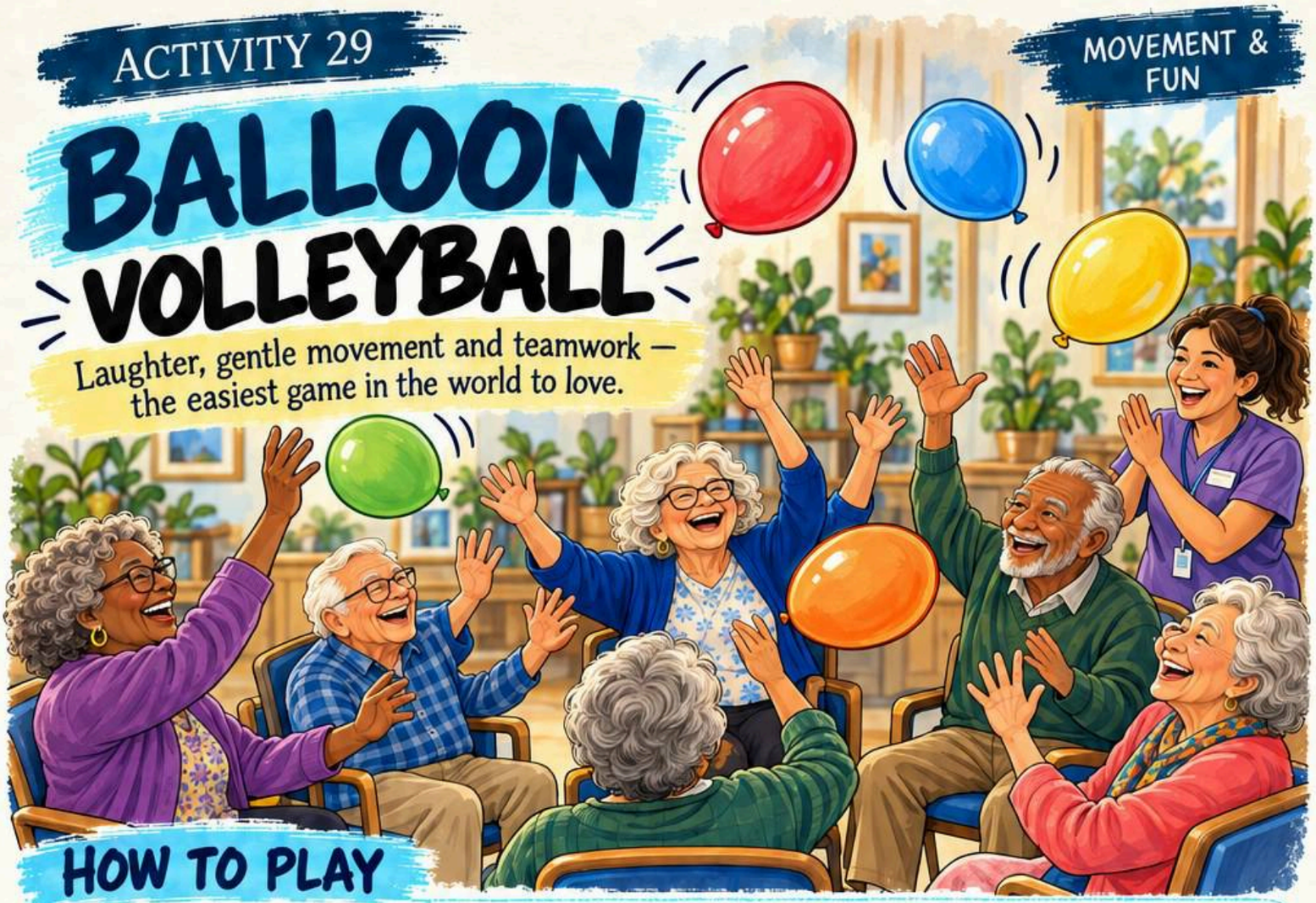
Point to one square at a time. Close enough is perfect.

ACTIVITY 29

MOVEMENT & FUN

BALLOON VOLLEYBALL

Laughter, gentle movement and teamwork — the easiest game in the world to love.



HOW TO PLAY

1 SIT IN A CIRCLE
Chairs a safe distance apart.



2 TAP THE BALLOON
Keep it in the air!



3 COUNT TOGETHER
How many taps before it lands?



GAME IDEAS

Say a name before you tap.



Use a pool noodle.



Two balloons at once.



Say a word for each letter A, B, C...



MATERIALS NEEDED



Balloons



Sturdy chairs



Pool noodles (optional)

CAREGIVER TIP

Use sturdy chairs without wheels and clear the space. Latex-free balloons are safest.

ROAD TRIP USA



Explore famous places and remember where they are in the USA. ♡

Buckle up! Match each famous landmark to its state.

LANDMARKS	STATES
 Statue of Liberty	Texas 
 Golden Gate Bridge	Washington 
 Mount Rushmore	New York 
 The Alamo	Missouri 
 Gateway Arch	California 
 Space Needle	South Dakota 

TALK ABOUT IT

- Which of these have you visited?
- What was your favorite road trip?



ANSWERS: Statue of Liberty–New York • Golden Gate Bridge–California • Mount Rushmore–South Dakota • The Alamo–Texas • Gateway Arch–Missouri • Space Needle–Washington

ACTIVITY 31

IMAGINATION & STORYTELLING

SHADOW THEATER

A lamp, a sheet and your hands — enough to tell a story everyone will remember.



HAND SHADOW IDEAS

Rabbit



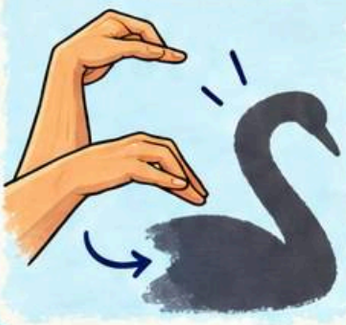
Bird



Dog



Swan



MATERIALS NEEDED



White sheet



Lamp or flashlight



Clothespins

STEP BY STEP

1 SET THE STAGE

Hang a light sheet, lamp behind it.



2 DIM THE LIGHTS

Turn off the room lights.



3 MAKE SHAPES

Try a rabbit, a bird, a dog.



4 TELL A STORY

Let the shadows act it out!



CAREGIVER TIP

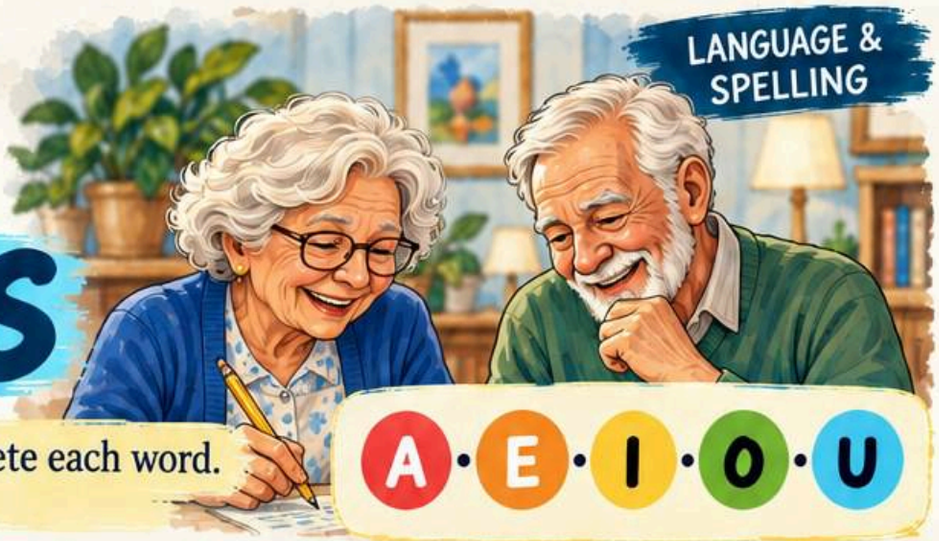
Keep a small light on for safety.
Invite everyone to name the characters.

A little imagination can make a big, happy story. ♡

ACTIVITY 32

LANGUAGE & SPELLING

MISSING VOWELS



Add the missing vowels to complete each word.
The pictures will help!

A · E · I · O · U

1 G□RD□N



_ _ _ _ _

2 S□NSH□N□



_ _ _ _ _ _

3 P□CN□C



_ _ _ _

4 GR□NDM□



_ _ _ _ _

5 P□RCH



_ _ _ _

6 B□S□B□LL



_ _ _ _

7 C□K□



_ _ _ _

8 R□D□□



_ _ _ _ _

CAREGIVER TIP

Say the word slowly with the picture.
Spelling doesn't need to be perfect.

ANSWERS:

GARDEN · SUNSHINE · PICNIC · GRANDMA · PORCH · BASEBALL · CAKE · RADIO

ACTIVITY 33

SENSES & RELAXATION

HOMEMADE AROMATHERAPY

Familiar scents can calm, refresh and bring back sweet memories.



SCENT LIBRARY



Lavender
calm



Orange
cheerful



Peppermint
fresh



Cinnamon
cozy



Rosemary
alert



Vanilla
comfort

STEP BY STEP

1 CHOOSE A SCENT
Use herbs, peels or spices.



2 PREPARE
Place it in a small jar or on a cotton pad.



3 SMELL SLOWLY
Breathe in gently.



4 SHARE
What does this remind you of?



CAREGIVER TIP

Use natural items like peels and herbs. Keep scents mild and avoid direct contact with skin.

"A familiar scent can open the door to a wonderful memory." ♡

ACTIVITY 34

STRATEGY & VISUAL PERCEPTION

COLOR DOMINOES

Classic dominoes made easier: match colors instead of counting dots.

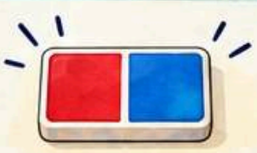


HOW TO PLAY

1. **DEAL**
   Give each player 5 color tiles.



2. **START**
   Place one tile in the middle.



3. **MATCH**
   Connect a tile with the same color.



4. **WIN**
   First to place all tiles wins!



MATERIALS NEEDED

Color domino tiles (or cardboard rectangles painted in two colors)



MAKE IT HARDER:

Use classic dot dominoes and count the dots.



SAMPLE COLOR TILES



CAREGIVER TIP

Large tiles are easier to grab.
Play in teams to keep everyone involved.

ALPHABET GARDEN

For each letter, write a fruit, vegetable or flower. Let your garden grow!



A _____

B _____

C _____

D _____

E _____

F _____

G _____

H _____

I _____

J _____

K _____

L _____

M _____

Stuck? Skip it and come back later. ♡



CAREGIVER TIP

Give a hint like "It's red and grows on a vine..." — guessing together is half the fun.

THE MEMORY PHONE CALL

A familiar voice can brighten the whole day.
Schedule a call full of memories.



CONVERSATION STARTERS

- Do you remember when we...?
- What's new in your life?
- Tell me about the grandkids.

STEP BY STEP

1 PLAN

Choose a family member or old friend.



2 PREPARE

Pick 2 or 3 memories to talk about.



3 CALL

Use speakerphone or a video call.



4 SAVE IT

Write down one happy moment from the call.



MATERIALS NEEDED



Phone or tablet



List of phone numbers



Notepad

CAREGIVER TIP

Turn up the volume and reduce background noise. A short, happy call is better than a long, tiring one.

GROCERY LIST MEMORY

Study the list for one minute. Then fold the page and answer the questions.



Fold the page here after 1 minute

ANSWER THE QUESTIONS

1 How many items were on the list?

2 Which fruit was on the list? (write both)



3 Was there something to drink? What?



4 Write as many items as you remember:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____
6. _____
7. _____
8. _____

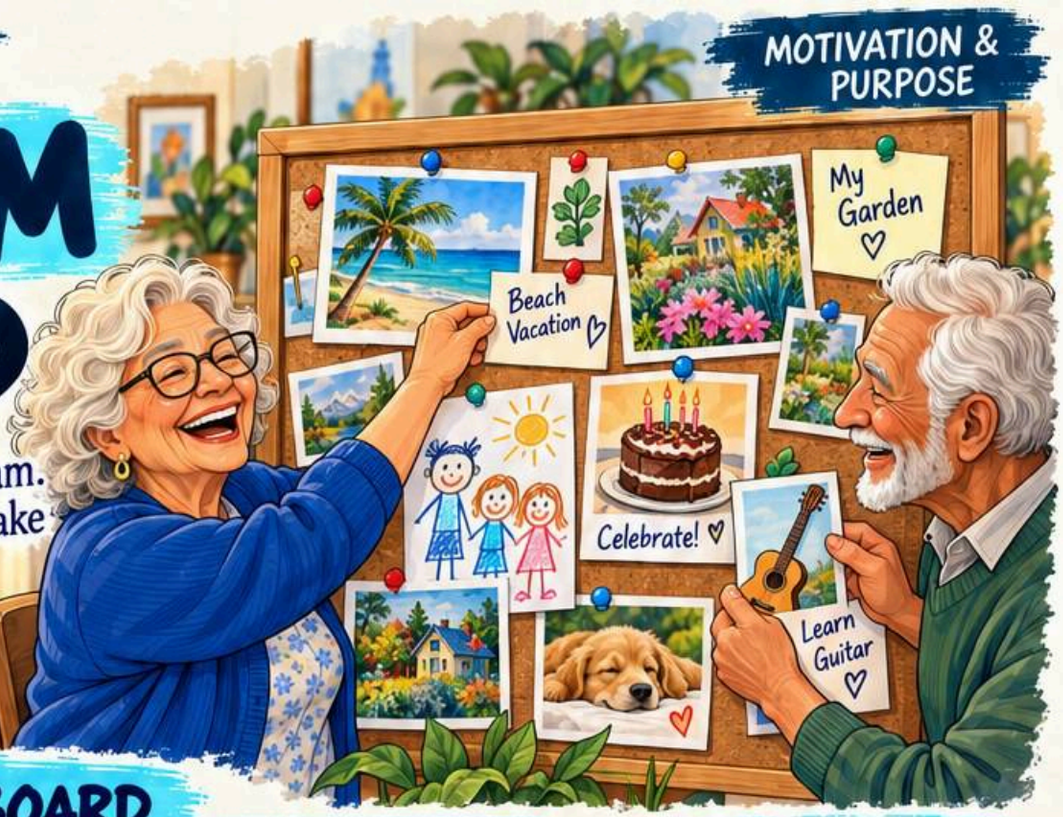


CAREGIVER TIP

Turn it into a real trip: take the list to the store and check items off together.

DREAM BOARD

It's never too late to dream. Picture the things that make life sweet.



YOUR DREAM BOARD

A place I'd love to visit

Something I want to learn

People I love

A favorite treat

A hobby that makes me happy

A wish for this year

STEP BY STEP

1 COLLECT
Magazines, photos, postcards.

2 CUT
Choose pictures that feel good.

3 PIN OR GLUE
Arrange them on a board.

4 SHARE
Tell the story behind each picture.

MATERIALS NEEDED



Cork board or poster | Old magazines | Scissors | Glue or pins

CAREGIVER TIP

Dreams can be small: a picnic, a phone call, a new recipe. Help make one come true this month.

ACTIVITY 39

LANGUAGE & ASSOCIATION

OPPOSITES MATCH



Draw a line from each word to its opposite.

HOT	SAD
UP	EMPTY
DAY	COLD
BIG	NIGHT
HAPPY	SLOW
OPEN	DOWN
FAST	CLOSED
FULL	SMALL

BONUS

Write 3 more pairs of opposites:



_____ ↔ _____

_____ ↔ _____

_____ ↔ _____

CAREGIVER TIP

Act them out! Lift your arms for UP, lower them for DOWN.



COLOR RACE

Roll the color die, move your token and cheer each other on to the finish!

HOW TO PLAY

1 ROLL – Roll the color die.



2 MOVE – Go to the next square of that color.



3 FUN SQUARES – Do what the square says.



4 FINISH – First to the finish wins!



MATERIALS NEEDED



Color die (or a regular die with colors)



Tokens or buttons



This board

CAREGIVER TIP

Play in pairs so everyone keeps up. The fun squares are where the laughter happens.

FINGER PAINTING

Feel the colors! A joyful, hands-on way to create without rules.



FINGER-PAINT IDEAS



Fingerprint flowers



Birds on a branch



Rainbow



Sunshine

STEP BY STEP

1 PREPARE
Cover the table, pour small paint puddles.



2 DIP
One finger, one color.



3 PAINT
Dots, lines, swirls.



4 DISPLAY
Sign it and show it off!



MATERIALS NEEDED



Non-toxic washable paint



Thick paper



Apron



Wet towels

CAREGIVER TIP

Some people dislike messy hands — offer a cotton swab instead. Comfort comes first.



ACTIVITY 42

ASSOCIATION & LANGUAGE

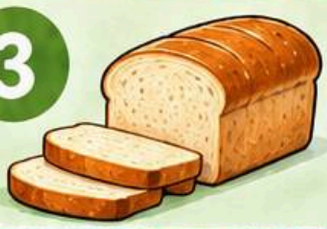
PERFECT PAIRS

Some things just belong together. Complete each famous pair!



1  Salt & _____

2  Peanut butter & _____

3  Bread & _____

4  Macaroni & _____

5  Milk & _____

6  Rock & _____

7  Thuinder & _____

8  Bacon & _____

9  Cup & _____

10  Hugs & _____

CAREGIVER TIP

Say the first word with rhythm and pause — the partner usually pops out.

ANSWERS:

pepper · jelly · butter · cheese · cookies · roll · lightning · eggs · saucer · kisses

ACTIVITY 43

FINE MOTOR & CREATIVITY

CLAY SCULPTING

Squeeze, roll and shape — strengthening the hands while the imagination plays.



STEP BY STEP

1 WARM UP
Squeeze the clay to soften it.



2 ROLL
Make balls and snakes.



3 SHAPE
Press, pinch and smooth.



4 DRY & PAINT
Let it dry, then add color.



EASY PROJECTS

Pinch pot



Little bird



Leaf print tile



Fruit basket



MATERIALS NEEDED



Air-dry clay or play dough



Placemat



Plastic knife



Paint (optional)

BENEFITS



Hand strength



Focus



Sense of accomplishment

CAREGIVER TIP

Soft play dough is easier for stiff hands. Warm it in your palms first.

GUIDED MEDITATION

Read slowly in a soft voice. Pause between each line.



1. Close your eyes and take a slow, deep breath.



2. Imagine a quiet lake on a warm morning.



3. Feel the gentle sun on your face.



4. Listen to the birds and the soft water.



5. Take one more deep breath... and slowly open your eyes.



CAREGIVER TIP

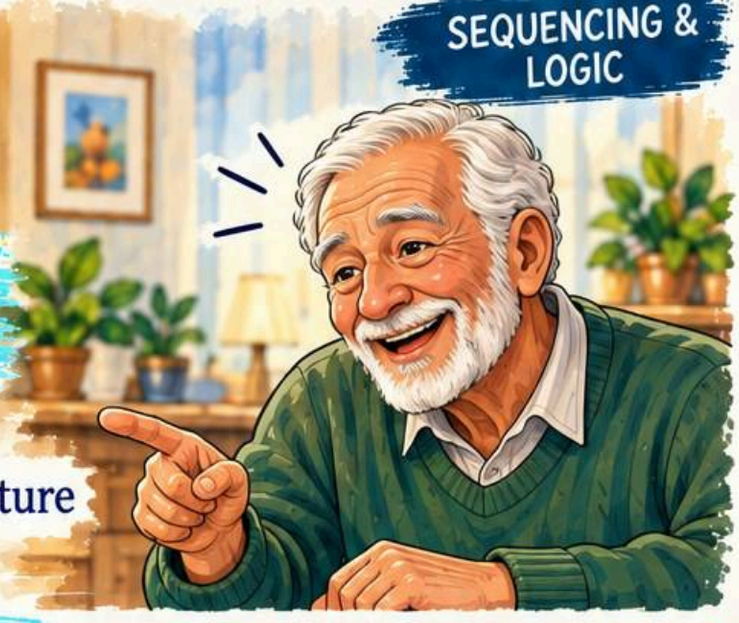
Play soft music in the background.
3 to 5 minutes is perfect.

"Peace is always just one breath away."

ACTIVITY 45

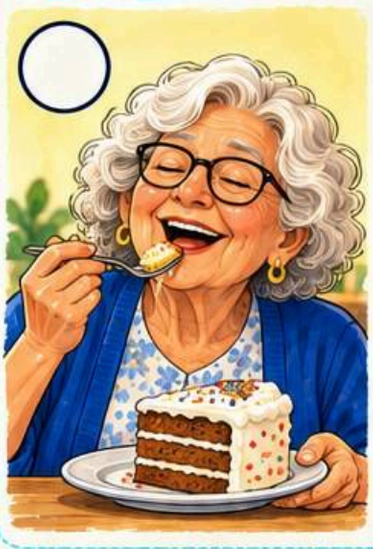
SEQUENCING & LOGIC

PUT IT IN ORDER



What happens first? Number each picture from 1 to 4.

STORY A — Baking a cake









STORY B — Planting a flower









CAREGIVER TIP

Talk through each picture first: "What's happening here?"

ANSWERS: A: 4-2-3-1 · B: 4-1-2-3

MEMORY SCRAPBOOK

Gather photos, tickets and little treasures — and turn them into a book of life.



PAGE IDEAS

My wedding day

Our first home

Family vacations

Favorite pets

Holidays together

STEP BY STEP

1 GATHER – Photos, cards, tickets, ribbons.



2 CHOOSE A THEME – One page, one story.



3 ARRANGE & GLUE – Add stickers and color.



4 WRITE A CAPTION – Who, where and when.



MATERIALS NEEDED


Scrapbook or binder



Photos & keepsakes


Glue stick

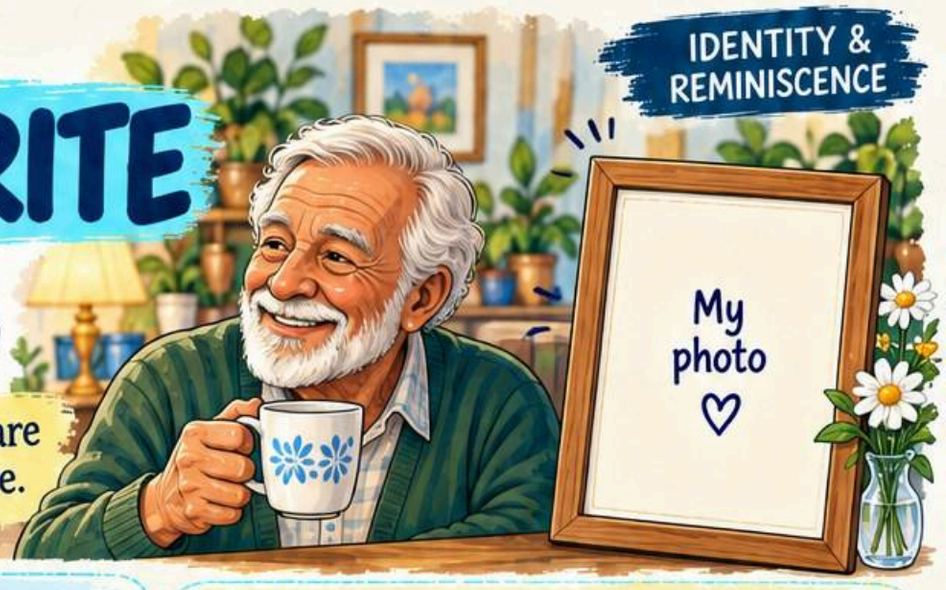

Markers & stickers

CAREGIVER TIP

Use copies of precious photos. Write the captions in the person's own words.

MY FAVORITE THINGS

Fill in your favorites — then share the page with someone you love.



My favorite song

_____

_____

My favorite food



_____

_____

My favorite place



_____

_____

My favorite movie



_____

_____

My favorite season



_____

_____

My favorite holiday





_____

_____

My favorite color



_____

_____

My favorite animal



_____

_____

Something that always makes me laugh



_____

_____

Best advice I ever got



_____

_____

CAREGIVER TIP

Make a copy and keep it in the person's room — it's a great conversation starter for visitors and staff.

THANKSGIVING MEMORES

Every holiday table holds a hundred stories. Let's share a few.



GRATITUDE PLACEMAT

This year I'm thankful for...

_____

_____

_____

TALK ABOUT IT

- Who hosted Thanksgiving when you were young?
- What dish was always on the table?
- What's the funniest holiday moment you remember?
- What family tradition do you love most?

CAREGIVER TIP

Bring a real holiday item – a pie tin, a tablecloth, a recipe card – to spark memories.



> "Gratitude turns our memories into treasure."

ACTIVITY 49

MUSIC & MEMORY

FINISH THE LYRIC

Sing it out loud! Fill in the missing word of each classic song.



1. You are my sunshine, my only _____.
2. Take me out to the ball _____.
3. Row, row, row your _____.
4. Home, home on the _____.
5. I've been working on the _____.
6. She'll be coming 'round the _____.
7. Twinkle, twinkle, little _____.
8. This land is your land, this land is my _____.



CAREGIVER TIP

Hum the tune first. Music memory often lasts longer than any other kind.

ANSWERS: sunshine · game · boat · range · railroad · mountain · star · land

ACTIVITY 50

TOUCH & WELL-BEING

HAND SPA DAY

Gentle touch, warm water and a little lotion — simple care that feels like love.

SPA STATION



Bowl of warm water



Soft towel



Hand lotion



Nail file



Relaxing music

STEP BY STEP

1 SOAK – Warm water for 2–3 minutes.



2 DRY – Pat gently with a soft towel.



3 MASSAGE – Small circles with lotion on palms and fingers.



4 FINISH – File nails and admire those hands!



WHILE YOU PAMPER, ASK:

What work did these hands do over the years? ♡



CAREGIVER TIP

Check the water temperature and ask for permission before touching. Go slowly and watch for comfort.

"Caring hands, grateful hearts." ♡